

Word family: **film / films / filmed / filming / filmmaker / filmmaking**

Base word: film

Plural: films

Past tense: filmed

Past participle: filmed

** -ing form:** filming

Related forms: filmmaker, filmmaking

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “He loves talking about old Hong Kong, unusual people he interviewed, books, **films**, and the tiny details that most of us walk straight past.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **films** means **movies: complete works of moving-image entertainment or storytelling**.

繁體中文： **由連續影像組成、通常配有聲音並用來講故事、記錄事情或娛樂觀眾的電影作品

中文翻譯：

> “He loves talking about old Hong Kong, unusual people he interviewed, books, **films**...”

「他很喜歡談舊香港、他曾經訪問過的特別人物、書本、**電影**.....」

Here:

film = 電影作品

1. **film = movie / motion picture (電影作品) — 電影**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A complete work consisting of moving images, usually with sound, made for cinema, television, or other viewing platforms.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He loves talking about books, **films**, and the tiny details that most of us walk straight past.”

「他很喜歡談書本、**電影**，以及那些大部分人會直接忽略的小細節。」

Practice 2

> “We watched a French **film** last night.”

「我們昨晚看了一部法國**電影**。」

Practice 3

> “The **film** tells the story of a family living in Hong Kong.”

「這部**電影**講述一個住在香港的家庭的故事。」

film = 以連續活動影像構成、作為完整作品供觀眾觀看的電影

Regional note

Film and **movie** overlap heavily.

* **film** is especially common in British English and in more formal/artistic contexts.

* **movie** is especially common in everyday American English.

2. **film** = material used to record photographic images (攝影膠卷) — 菲林 ; 膠卷

This is a genuinely different physical meaning.

Meaning: A thin strip or sheet coated with light-sensitive material used in traditional photography or motion-picture recording.

Practice 4

> “I still have several rolls of old camera **film**.”

「我仍然保留着幾卷舊相機**菲林 / 膠卷**。」

Practice 5

> “This camera uses 35mm **film**.”

「這部相機使用 35 毫米**菲林**。」

film = 傳統攝影中用來感光並記錄影像的薄片或膠卷材料

This is clearly different from:

> “I watched a film.”

= 我看了一部電影。

versus:

> “I bought some film.”

= 我買了一些菲林 / 膠卷。

3. **film** = very thin layer covering a surface (薄膜 / 薄層) — 薄膜；薄薄一層

This is another major noun meaning.

Meaning: A very thin layer of a substance covering a surface.

Practice 6

> “A thin **film** of dust covered the table.”

「桌面覆蓋着一層薄薄的**灰塵**。」

Practice 7

> “There was a greasy **film** on the surface of the water.”

「水面上有一層油膩的**薄膜**。」

film = 覆蓋在物體表面的一層非常薄的物質

Common examples:

- * film of dust
- * film of oil
- * film of moisture
- * protective film

These share the same underlying “thin layer” concept.

4. **film** + event/person/place (拍攝) — 拍攝；攝錄

As a verb, **film** means to record moving images with a camera.

Practice 8

> “They **filmed** the interview in his apartment.”

「他們在他的公寓裡**拍攝 / 攝錄**了那次訪問。」

Practice 9

> “Someone was **filming** the concert on a phone.”

「有人正用手機**拍攝**那場音樂會。」

film something = 使用攝影機、手機或其他設備把活動影像記錄下來

This is a distinct verb use.

5. **film** = make a movie / produce scenes for a movie (製作電影) — 拍電影；拍攝影片

Closely related to Meaning 4, **film** can refer more broadly to creating the visual material for a movie or programme.

Practice 10

> “The director **filmed** several scenes in Hong Kong.”

「導演在香港**拍攝**了幾個場景。」

Practice 11

> “The series was **filmed** entirely on location.”

「這套劇集全程在實景地點**拍攝**。」

film = 為電影、節目或其他影像作品拍攝活動影像

For database purposes, I would **merge** this with Meaning 4 because the core concept remains:

> **record moving images with a camera**

The subject matter changes, but the semantic action does not.

6. **film over / become covered with a film (表面) — 覆上一層薄膜；變得朦朧**

This develops from the “thin layer” noun meaning.

Practice 12

> “Steam **filmed** the mirror.”

「蒸氣令鏡面**蒙上一層薄霧**。」

Practice 13

> “His eyes **filmed over** with tears.”

「他的眼睛因淚水而**蒙上一層水光 / 變得朦朧**。」

The basic idea is:

****a surface becomes covered by a thin layer****

Because this often appears as ****film over****, I would treat it as a contextual extension of the thin-layer sense rather than inflate the core database count.

Related form: ****filming****

****Filming**** means the activity or process of recording moving images.

Practice 14

> “****Filming**** will begin next month.”

「****拍攝工作****將於下個月開始。」

Practice 15

> “The street was closed during ****filming****.”

「****拍攝期間****，那條街道被封閉。」

****filming = 拍攝電影、節目、影片或其他活動影像的過程****

Related form: ****filmmaker****

A ****filmmaker**** is someone involved in making films, especially creatively or professionally.

Practice 16

> “She is an independent ****filmmaker****.”

「她是一位獨立****電影製作人 / 電影工作者****。」

Practice 17

> “The young ****filmmaker**** won an international award.”

「那位年輕****電影製作人****獲得了一個國際獎項。」

****filmmaker = 參與策劃、導演或製作電影作品的人****

Related form: ****filmmaking****

****Filmmaking**** means the art or process of creating films.

Practice 18

> “He studied ****filmmaking**** at university.”

「他在大學修讀****電影製作****。」

Practice 19

> “Digital technology has changed modern ****filmmaking****.”

「數碼科技改變了現代****電影製作方式****。」

****filmmaking = 從構思、拍攝到製作電影作品的整體過程或藝術****

Important distinction: ****film vs movie****

These usually refer to the same type of work.

****film****

More common in:

- * British English
- * formal discussion
- * criticism
- * artistic contexts

> “It’s an excellent film.”

movie

Especially common in everyday American English.

> “Do you want to watch a movie?”

In most ordinary contexts:

film ≈ movie = 電影

But **movie** does not normally have the other senses of **film**:

- > camera film
- > a film of oil

You cannot normally substitute **movie** there.

Important distinction: **film vs video**

film

can mean a complete movie or the process of recording moving images.

video

can mean recorded moving-image content more broadly, often digital and possibly short or informal.

> “I watched a two-minute video.”

does not normally imply a complete movie.

So:

film = often a complete cinematic work

****video = broader recorded moving-image content****

Important distinction: ****film vs photograph****

****film — verb****

records ****moving images****

> “She filmed the performance.”

「她把表演拍攝下來。」

****photograph — verb****

records a ****still image****

> “She photographed the building.”

「她拍攝了那座建築物的照片。」

Modern phones can do both, but the verbs still distinguish the type of result.

Important distinction: ****film — movie vs film — thin layer****

Compare:

> “There was a good ****film**** on television.”

= 電視上有一部好電影。

> “There was a thin ****film**** of oil on the water.”

= 水面上有一層薄薄的油膜。

These require completely different mental concepts, so they should definitely remain separate under the SOP.

Family-extension note

The useful modern family includes:

- * **film**
- * **films**
- * **filmed**
- * **filming**
- * **filmmaker**
- * **filmmaking**

Useful compounds include:

- * **film industry**
- * **film director**
- * **film studio**
- * **film festival**
- * **film crew**
- * **film camera**
- * **film critic**
- * **film set**

These are useful compounds, but they do not create new meanings of bare **film** merely because the following noun changes. The Golden Manual says compounds should be included when educationally useful but labelled separately from true polysemy.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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film — movie	由連續活動影像構成、通常配有聲音並作為完整作品供觀眾觀看的電影
film — photographic material	傳統攝影中用來感光並記錄影像的膠卷或菲林材料
film — thin layer	覆蓋在物體表面的一層非常薄的物質
film — verb	使用攝影機、手機或其他設備記錄活動影像
film over / surface becomes filmed	某個表面覆上一層極薄物質而變得朦朧或被遮蓋；屬於「薄層」義的延伸
filming	拍攝電影、節目或其他活動影像的過程
filmmaker	參與策劃、導演或製作電影作品的人
filmmaking	創作和製作電影的整體過程或藝術

For your original sentence

> “He loves talking about old Hong Kong, unusual people he interviewed, books, **films**...”

The exact meaning is:

****film = 作為完整作品供觀眾觀看的電影****

So:

> ****books and films****

= ****書籍和電影****

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely distinct core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings**** for ****film****:

1. ****movie / motion picture****
2. ****photographic film material****
3. ****thin layer covering a surface****
4. ****verb — record moving images****

I would merge ****filming a movie / filming an interview / filming on a phone**** under #4, and treat ****film over**** as an extension of the ****thin-layer**** meaning rather than a separate core sense.